evidenced by the references that Hirachand made to the Indian Mercantile Marine Committee. When the rate war began, a well-prepared Scindia readily took up the challenge. Realizing that Scindia was no pushover, in 1922, Lord Inchcape authorized negotiations after having cold-shouldered Lalubhai Samaldas barely a year earlier. Initially, BI made an insolent offer to buy out Scindia. Despite being hard-nosed businessmen, a meeting of major shareholders turned it down—demonstrating that they were cut of a different fabric from SSNCo's directors. Eventually, in 1923, a ten-year agreement was signed between Scindia and BI: the rate war ended but at a stiff price. Scindia was to keep off passenger traffic and overseas operations, confining itself to coastal trade and to restrict its gross tonnage to 70,000. Hirachand aptly, if despondently, called it 'a slavery bond'[14] but Scindia lived to fight another day.

Morarjee and Hirachand maintained excellent personal relations with the Indian National Congress and its leaders such as Gandhi, Nehru and Patel. With Samaldas as a member of the Indian Mercantile Marine Committee, Scindia lobbied effectively on behalf of Indian shipping interests. In the committee itself, at least three of the Scindia management provided evidence and 'ably stood up to [the] oral examination'. And the experience of SSNCo came up more than once in the exchanges that Scindia's representatives had with the committee. Against the heaviest odds, Scindia offered support to indigenous shipping enterprise in various ways: for instance, it bailed out Abdool Baree Choudhury's Bengal Burma Steam Navigation Company and established the Indian National Steamship Owners' Association in 1930.

Scindia continued to remember VOC on various occasions. M.A. Master's writings are peppered with references to the SSNCo,[15] as is the Scindia's golden jubilee volume.[16] Fittingly, when Vallabhbhai Patel launched the Scindia steamer, *Jal Prabha*, he paid tribute to VOC.